B2

BONUS 2

Recovery & Post-Fall Exercises

60 progressive activities across 4 phases — from acute bed rest through to full community activity resumption.

60 Activities | 4 Phases | Progressive Rehab | Safe Return

SENIOR ACTIVITY VAULT · PROFESSIONAL EDITION



SECTION 1

Phase 1: Acute (Weeks 1–2)

Breathing, gentle range of motion, circulation exercises, and supported repositioning for the immediate post-fall or post-surgery period.

- Controlled breathing
- Bed-based circulation
- Isometric muscle activation
- Supported positional changes



Controlled Deep Breathing

★ Independent

Establish diaphragmatic breathing to expand lungs and prevent respiratory complications during bed rest.

1. Lie on back or sit supported.
2. Place one hand on belly.
3. Inhale slowly through nose for 4 counts.
4. Exhale fully for 6 counts; 10 breaths × 3 sessions daily.

Supported Neck Retraction

★ Independent

Gently retract the chin to prevent forward head posture during prolonged bed rest.

1. Lie with head on pillow.
2. Draw chin gently back without lifting.
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Release; 10 reps every 2 hours.

Ankle Pumps Phase 1

★ Independent

Flex and point feet continuously to maintain circulation and prevent deep vein thrombosis.

1. Lie flat or slightly elevated.
2. Flex feet toward body firmly.
3. Point toes away.
4. Repeat 20 times every hour.

Wrist and Finger Mobility

★ Independent

Move hands and wrists through their range during bed rest to maintain upper limb readiness.

1. Hold arms in front.
2. Bend and straighten wrists 10 times.
3. Open and close fists 10 times.
4. Circle wrists 10 times each direction.

Bed Repositioning Technique

★ Independent

Learn safe techniques for repositioning in bed to reduce pain and prevent skin breakdown.

1. Therapist demonstrates: bend knees, plant feet, bridge and shift.
2. Participant practises bridging.
3. Practise lateral rolling with bent knees.
4. Perform every 2 hours during waking.

Isometric Quad Sets

★ Independent

Tighten the thigh muscle against the bed to maintain quad strength during bed rest.

1. Lie flat; place a rolled towel under right knee.
2. Tighten quad, pressing knee into towel.
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Release; 15 reps; alternate legs.

Isometric Glute Squeeze

★ Independent

Squeeze the buttock muscles together to maintain glute activation during bed rest.

1. Lie flat or sit.
2. Squeeze both buttocks together firmly.
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Release; 15 reps.

Supported Shoulder Mobilisation

★ Independent

Move the shoulder through a gentle range with support to prevent stiffness.

1. Lie on back; arm by side.
2. Therapist supports arm; gently raises to 90° forward.
3. Hold 3 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 8 reps each side.

Breathing with Arm Raise

★ Independent

Coordinate an arm raise with each deep inhalation to expand lung volume.

1. Lie on back; arms at sides.
2. Inhale deeply; raise arms to overhead.
3. Hold breath at top 2 seconds.
4. Exhale; lower arms; 10 reps.

Gentle Hip Rotation

★ Independent

Roll hips gently from side to side to maintain lumbar mobility during bed rest.

1. Lie flat; knees bent.
2. Let knees drift slowly right 20 degrees.
3. Return to centre; drift left.
4. 10 gentle rotations each side.

Pelvic Floor Contractions

★ Independent

Contract pelvic floor muscles to maintain continence and core stability.

1. Lie comfortably; find pelvic floor muscles.
2. Contract (as if stopping urine flow).
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Release fully; 15 reps × 3 sets.

Gentle Leg Slides

★ Independent

Slide the leg along the bed surface to begin gentle hip flexion in the acute phase.

1. Lie flat; slide right heel slowly toward buttock.
2. Bend knee as far as comfortable.
3. Slowly return to flat.
4. 8 reps each leg.

Mindful Pain Acknowledgement

★ Independent

Practise observing pain without catastrophising to manage fear-avoidance responses.

1. Sit or lie comfortably.
2. Rate pain from 0–10.
3. Breathe into the area; visualise pain as a colour softening.
4. Re-rate after 5 minutes.

Supported Sitting Edge

★★ Assisted

Sit upright on the edge of the bed with support to begin vertical tolerance.

1. Therapist supports at side.
2. Participant sits at edge, feet dangling.
3. Hold position for 1 minute.
4. Return to lying; repeat 3 times.

Ice or Warmth Application

★ Independent

Apply ice or heat to sore areas under therapist guidance to manage pain and enable movement.

1. Identify area of pain with therapist.
2. Apply ice pack (wrapped) for 10 minutes.
3. Remove and assess for movement improvement.
4. Document response for care team.



SECTION 2

Phase 2: Mobilization (Weeks 3–4)

Sit to stand, short walks with aid, basic balance, and supported stair practice as strength and confidence return.

- Supervised sit-to-stand
- Short corridor walks
- Supported balance retraining
- Stair negotiation phase 2





Sit-to-Stand Phase 2

★★ Assisted

Progress to sit-to-stand from a raised chair with minimal support.

1. Use raised chair or chair with cushion.
2. Lean forward; push through heels.
3. Stand fully; hold 5 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 8 reps twice daily.



Short Corridor Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk a short corridor distance with a walking aid to begin gait restoration.

1. Begin with appropriate aid (frame or stick).
2. Walk 5–10 metres at comfortable pace.
3. Turn; walk back.
4. Rest; track distance progress weekly.



Basic Balance Stand

★★ Assisted

Stand holding a bar for 30 seconds to begin static balance retraining.

1. Stand at parallel bars; hold firmly.
2. Hold standing position 30 seconds.
3. Rest 1 minute.
4. Repeat 5 times.

Step Touch Beside Bed

★★ Assisted

Step side to side beside the bed with hand support to restore stepping confidence.

1. Stand beside bed; left hand on mattress.
2. Step right foot 30 cm right.
3. Bring left foot to meet it.
4. 20 side steps each direction.

Supported Heel Raises

★★ Assisted

Rise onto toes with full bar support to begin calf strength restoration.

1. Hold bars firmly; stand tall.
2. Rise slowly onto toes.
3. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 15 reps.

Chair Squats

★★ Assisted

Partial sit-to-stand repetitions to progressively load the lower limbs.

1. Sit at chair edge; stand to halfway.
2. Hold semi-squat 3 seconds.
3. Lower back to sitting.
4. 10 reps; progress to full stand.

Walking Stick Gait

★★ Assisted

Practise correct stick gait pattern (stick with affected leg) for community walking readiness.

1. Stick in opposite hand to affected leg.
2. Move stick and affected leg simultaneously.
3. Step through with unaffected leg.
4. Walk 20 metres; therapist observes.

Stair Negotiation Phase 2

★★★ Supported

Ascend and descend 3–4 stairs with two-rail support to restore stair function.

1. Hold both rails; face upstairs.
2. Lead with stronger leg ascending.
3. Lead with weaker leg descending.
4. 5 ascent-descent cycles.

Side-Lying Hip Strengthening

★★ Assisted

Lift the top leg in side-lying to progressively load the hip abductors.

1. Lie on side on mat.
2. Lift top leg 30 cm.
3. Hold 3 seconds.
4. Lower slowly; 12 reps each side.

Doorway Balance Challenge

★★ Assisted

Stand in a doorway with hands near frame to practise reducing reliance on support.

1. Stand in doorway; fingertips touching frame.
2. Release one hand; stand 10 seconds.
3. Release both hands for 5 seconds.
4. Repeat 5 times.

Bridge Progression

★★ Assisted

Progress from flat bridge to single-leg bridge to increase glute loading.

1. Begin with double-leg bridge (10 reps).
2. Progress to single-leg bridge when tolerated.
3. Hold each single-leg bridge 3 seconds.
4. 10 reps each leg.

Marching in Place

★★ Assisted

March with high knees at a bar to build hip flexion strength for walking.

1. Hold bars; stand tall.
2. Lift right knee to hip height.
3. Alternate legs in marching pattern.
4. March 30 seconds; rest; 3 rounds.

Functional Reach Standing

★★ Assisted

Reach forward while standing to challenge dynamic balance in the sub-acute phase.

1. Stand with light bar support.
2. Extend both arms forward at shoulder height.
3. Lean forward slightly; hold 3 seconds.
4. Return; 8 reps.

Ankle Strengthening Phase 2

★★ Assisted

Perform resisted ankle movements to restore ankle stability for safe walking.

1. Sit at edge of chair; resistance band on foot.
2. Flex foot toward body against band.
3. Hold 2 seconds.
4. Return slowly; 12 reps each direction.

Proprioception Retraining

★★ Assisted

Stand on a slightly unstable surface to begin retraining joint position sense after injury.

1. Stand on folded towel with light bar support.
2. Hold 20 seconds; note any ankle wobble.
3. Progress to eyes closed.
4. 5 rounds each leg.



SECTION 3

Phase 3: Strengthening (Weeks 5–8)

Progressive resistance work, balance challenges, stair training, and outdoor preparation to restore functional strength.

- Progressive resistance loading
- Balance pad and foam work
- Lateral band walking
- Eccentric and step work



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Progressive Resistance Leg Press

★★ Assisted

Push feet against a resistance band from sitting to progressively load the lower limbs.

1. Sit in chair; band around both feet.
2. Push feet forward against band.
3. Hold 3 seconds.
4. Return slowly; 12 reps.

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Step-Up Progression

★★ Assisted

Ascend a low step with decreasing support as strength returns.

1. Step 1: use two rails; 10 reps.
2. Step 2: use one rail; 10 reps.
3. Step 3: no rail; therapist spots; 10 reps.
4. Increase step height as tolerated.

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Resistance Band Squat

★★ Assisted

Add resistance band to squat to increase quad and glute loading.

1. Stand on band; hold ends at shoulders.
2. Lower to quarter squat against band resistance.
3. Hold 3 seconds.
4. Stand; 12 reps.

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Single-Leg Stance Challenge

★★ Assisted

Stand on one leg without support for increasing durations.

1. Stand near wall; release support.
2. Balance on right leg for 10 seconds.
3. Switch legs.
4. Progress to 20 and 30 seconds.

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Balance Pad Stand

★★ Assisted

Stand on a foam pad to challenge proprioception during the strengthening phase.

1. Place foam pad near wall.
2. Step on; stand with light finger contact.
3. Release wall for 15 seconds.
4. Progress to eyes closed; 5 rounds.

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Walking with Resistance

★★ Assisted

Walk with a light resistance band around the thighs to improve hip strength in gait.

1. Place band around thighs just above knees.
2. Walk 10 metres maintaining step width.
3. Band creates resistance that activates glutes.
4. 3 laps; rest between.

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Wall Squat Hold

★★ Assisted

Hold a wall sit to build sustained quad endurance for prolonged standing.

1. Stand against wall; slide down to 45-degree knee bend.
2. Hold for 15 seconds.
3. Rest 30 seconds.
4. Progress toward 30 seconds per hold.

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Lunge Walk Assisted

★★★ Supported

Step forward into a lunge with rail support as an advanced loading progression.

1. Hold rail; stand at start.
2. Step right foot forward 50 cm.
3. Lower back knee 10 cm toward floor.
4. Push through front heel to recover; alternate; 8 lunges.

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Step-Down Eccentric

★★ Assisted

Lower the body slowly off a step to eccentrically load the quads.

1. Stand on step; hold rail.
2. Bend standing knee, lower non-standing foot slowly.
3. Touch floor gently.
4. Return to step; 10 reps each leg.

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Lateral Band Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk sideways with band around ankles to target hip abductors in a functional movement.

1. Place band around ankles.
2. Take 10 side steps right.
3. Maintain slight knee bend throughout.
4. Return 10 steps left; 3 rounds.

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Heel-Toe Walk Progression

★★ Assisted

Walk in tandem heel-to-toe pattern to restore narrow base confidence.

1. Mark a 3-metre line.
2. Walk heel-to-toe without holding wall.
3. Return.
4. Progress to 5 metres; track accuracy.

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Functional Stair Carry

★★★ Supported

Carry a light object while ascending stairs to practise dual-task stair function.

1. Hold a light book or cup.
2. Ascend 6 stairs with rail at one side.
3. Carry object in free hand.
4. Descend; 5 ascent-descent cycles.

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Outdoor Walk Preparation

★★ Assisted

Practise walking on different indoor textures to prepare for outdoor terrain.

1. Walk on carpet, tile, mat, and foam in sequence.
2. Use walking aid as needed.
3. Adjust pace and foot clearance for each surface.
4. Discuss outdoor surface challenges.

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Closed-Chain Hip Extension

★★ Assisted

Press one leg back against a wall while standing to strengthen glutes in a closed-chain position.

1. Stand 30 cm from wall; right foot touches wall behind.
2. Press right foot into wall firmly.
3. Hold 5 seconds.
4. Release; 10 reps each leg.

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Agility Cone Shuffle

★★★ Supported

Shuffle between two cones spaced 2 metres apart to build reactive agility.

1. Place two cones 2 metres apart.
2. Stand in middle; shuffle to right cone and touch.
3. Shuffle to left cone and touch.
4. Repeat 10 times; track time.



SECTION 4

Phase 4: Return to Activities (Week 9+)

Community walks, group participation, ADL restoration, and confidence-building activities for full activity resumption.

- Community and slope walks
- Bus stop and kerb work
- Grocery carry and dual-task
- Maintenance planning



Community Walk Phase 4

★★ Assisted

Walk in a real community setting with appropriate aid to restore outdoor confidence.

1. Choose a safe flat outdoor route.
2. Walk 200 metres at comfortable pace.
3. Increase by 100 metres each session.
4. Track weekly total distance.

Grocery Carry Walk

★★ Assisted

Carry a light bag while walking to simulate everyday community tasks.

1. Carry a bag weighing 0.5–1 kg.
2. Walk 100 metres at normal pace.
3. Switch hands halfway.
4. Increase weight by 0.5 kg weekly.

Group Walk

★ Independent

Participate in a supervised group walking programme to restore social walking confidence.

1. Join a walking group; choose a suitable pace group.
2. Walk for 10–20 minutes.
3. Converse while walking (dual task).
4. Record distance and any symptoms.



Slope Walk

★★ Assisted

Walk up and down a gentle slope to prepare for real-world terrain.

1. Choose a gentle outdoor slope.
2. Walk uphill at controlled pace.
3. Walk downhill; shorten steps and lean back slightly.
4. 3 return trips.



Bus Stop Simulation

★★ Assisted

Practise standing and waiting for several minutes to simulate community transport use.

1. Stand beside a support at simulated bus stop.
2. Hold position for 5 minutes.
3. Progress to standing without support.
4. Discuss: what to do if bus is late?



Kerb Negotiation Phase 4

★★ Assisted

Step up and down kerbs confidently without rail assistance.

1. Approach kerb with walking aid if needed.
2. Lead with stronger leg stepping up.
3. Lead with weaker leg stepping down.
4. Practise 10 up-down cycles.



Supermarket Walk Simulation

★★ Assisted

Walk a simulated shopping route, reaching for items at various heights.

1. Set up shelves at low, waist, and head height.
2. Walk between shelves; reach for items.
3. Place items in a basket.
4. Simulate queue waiting; standing 3 minutes.



Stair Flight Completion

★★ Assisted

Ascend and descend a full flight of 12–15 stairs independently.

1. Hold rail; ascend one full flight.
2. Rest at top 1 minute.
3. Descend one full flight.
4. Track time; aim for smooth confident pace.



Uneven Ground Walk

★★★ Supported

Walk on grass or gravel to restore tolerance for outdoor terrain variation.

1. Choose a grassy or gravel path.
2. Walk 50 metres at controlled pace.
3. Increase to 100 metres as confidence grows.
4. Discuss coping strategies.



Dual-Task Community Walk

★★★ Supported

Walk while performing a verbal task to restore dual-task performance in real settings.

1. Begin walking at normal pace.
2. Simultaneously name 5 animals.
3. Continue with months backward.
4. Assess: any gait change during task?



Return to Exercise Class

★ Independent

Begin participating in a supervised group exercise class at appropriate level.

1. Choose beginner exercise class.
2. Attend with a companion first time.
3. Participate in seated exercises.
4. Progress to standing component as tolerated.



Social Activity Resumption

★ Independent

Attend a social activity to rebuild confidence in community engagement.

1. Choose one weekly social event.
2. Plan transport and logistics.
3. Attend for 30–60 minutes initially.
4. Build duration and frequency over 4 weeks.



Home Task Progression

★★ Assisted

Practise household tasks such as cooking or laundry to restore ADL independence.

1. Identify one household task to practise.
2. Carry out task with OT supervision.
3. Identify any safety concerns.
4. Adapt the task if needed for safety.



Confidence Review

★ Independent

Rate confidence in daily activities and set goals for continued community participation.

1. Use a falls self-efficacy scale (rated 1–10).
2. Rate confidence for 10 common activities.
3. Identify top 3 areas for improvement.
4. Set one specific weekly goal for each.



Maintenance Exercise Plan

★ Independent

Develop a personalised ongoing exercise plan for long-term fall prevention.

1. Review progress: what exercises helped most?
2. Select 5 to continue independently at home.
3. Write a weekly schedule.
4. Review with therapist in 4 weeks.